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Jane Jarvis

In November of 1995, the American Federation of Jazz Societies honored Jane Jarvis with a jazz festival celebrating her 80th birthday and distinguished career in music. Her diverse achievements include record producing for the Muzak Corporation, official organist for the Milwaukee Braves and New York Mets, jazz performing, recording, arranging and an ever-increasing role as a lecturer and spokesperson for jazz education. She is a founding member and pianist for the Statesmen of Jazz, a group of veteran musicians whose goals include presenting jazz to young audiences across the country. She records frequently and can be found in the company of such stellar bassists as Milt Hinton and Jay Leonhart.

Jane was interviewed by Monk Rowe in Los Angeles on September 3, 1995.

MR: We are filming today for part of the Hamilton College Jazz Archive project. And it's a special day for us because today we have with us Jane Jarvis, and I barely know where to start with you. We could do I think about five or six separate interviews with the things you've done in your career. But I hope to get to some of those, anyway. Could I start out right now and tell us about this event you have coming up in November. It sounds so exciting.

JJ: Oh, I'm really delighted you asked about that because I've been preening myself ever since I was told that this was going to take place. A group of people, a small group of people, they began about three years ago asking me if they couldn't do this. And by this I mean have a jazz festival in my honor. I don't think it was altogether because of me, I think it was largely because they felt that women had been sort of passed over in jazz. And I just was lucky enough to be the person they chose to start this wonderful thing. So this is a jazz, a bona fide jazz festival, a three day affair, and it is being organized by Jazz Music Education, Inc., a group of interested people who worry about the eventuality of jazz and feel that the place to start is not only in colleges but as early as grade school and even kindergarten. And they feel that we should try to interest more people in the education part of jazz, as opposed to, in addition to performing. Because most of the degrees now that are given in jazz, I think I'm speaking with some knowledge of it, are people who are getting a degree actually in their instrument or in arranging in order to make a livelihood. But what we have been ignoring is the audience. Who is going to be the audience? And it seemed to me and it has to them, the Jazz Music Education folks, that if it could be introduced at a very young age, and you don't have to make an announcement and say "We are now going to hire a public school teacher who is going to insidiously teach jazz to children." But it can be done without so saying, just by exposure.

MR: Yeah. So it's not, so it's something that's kind of weaved into the fabric.

JJ: Yeah. It doesn't have to be a rigid attempt. That is what they're hopeful for. So they are establishing what they call a Jazz Music Education Scholarship. They're calling it the Jane Jarvis Jazz Piano Scholarship because it seems that most people understand that the real foundation instrument, tonality instrument, is jazz, or rather is piano. And they felt that in the beginning the more people who were interested in jazz piano that they could also be interested in the education of jazz. That it would be one step forward in that area that I spoke of. Now just, this is really almost a new concept in a way. And so just how far they're going to get with this, it may be that they'll have to alter the — the goal will always be the same but just how to attain it. At any rate, they have formed this not-for-profit organization and they have determined that they're going to operate it for a period of five years at the least. And by that time they hope to have this scholarship well established and be making an impact.

MR: Well it looks like an exciting event. You have some great guests coming in, and I hope I can get there.

JJ: Oh, I hope you can too, Monk, it's really going to be — the men that are playing are all men that I've worked with. They represent my life in music, actually. And did I mention that it will be my 80th birthday on that Saturday?

MR: Probably someone will play "Happy Birthday" that weekend I think, in an interesting arrangement I bet.

JJ: Well, undeniably.

MR: Well let me go back and we want to talk about the Statesmen too, but you were somewhat of a child prodigy from what I've read, and tell us about how that came about.

JJ: It sounds so vain to refer to yourself that way. But I must say I was very unusual. And I had the good fortune to be born to incredible parents. They were scholars. And neither of them were musicians. My father was an attorney and my mother was a school teacher that could teach everything but music. But they recognized that a three-year-old child who could go to the piano and copy anything heard, in a very fundamental way, and I'd come home and imitate snatches of phrases that I'd heard, imprinted on me you know. So they, as soon as I was able to understand they took me to our hometown university. That was in Vincennes, Indiana. They have a very nice little community college there. And the head of the piano department accepted me as his student.

MR: At what age?

JJ: Well I must have been about, I'm a little vague about this. I think somewhere between five and seven, something like that. And so she was an exceptional teacher. My parents recognized that if I were given the opportunity that I could fulfill their dreams for me. So I just had a grand start and was educated early, very early.

MR: And at this time was this the classical approach?

JJ: Oh, yes.

MR: But you obviously had an ear going for you from an early age, too.

JJ: Yeah. I had perfect pitch, and also it even goes farther than that. I have — everything in life is a sound to me. For example your speaking voice. I can almost tell you, I don't know whether you sing or not, but I can almost tell you what your range is, you know, from your speaking voice. Because your speaking voice has a series of sounds. And so that's a blessing and also inhibiting, because you find yourself preoccupied all the time.

MR: You can't get away from it if you want to. Tell us about how the staff piano player at this radio show came about.

JJ: My life has just been serendipity you know. My father saw, there in the *Gary Post Tribune*, this is Gary, Indiana we're talking about, that they were going to put on a children's radio show. So he thought well that would be nice, my daughter can play all these little pop tunes you know. So we were sitting in the waiting room, waiting for all these children to come in and perform, and there was a, I don't know what people were thinking, but there was one lady who had her child there who was a baton twirler. This is for radio now, mind you. And they had tap dancers, and the brought their piece of board that they could tap. And so—

MR: And they were all dressed up too of course, right?

JJ: To a tee, including the mothers and fathers. And so we were sitting in this waiting room and it was really getting very noisy because we'd all been sitting there an hour you know. And I was very well off, because across from the radio station, you know the next door, a band was rehearsing. And it was a jazz band. So my father says, well let's just go in there and see what's going on. And I sat and listened to it as long as I could, and to my father's astonishment I went up to the leader and asked him if I could sit in. I don't know what I said. I don't recall what I said. But these men just were so, just thought it was so hilarious you know, to have a little girl, I was eleven at this point. And so they let me sit in and I played, 'cause I knew all the tunes they were playing. And they just thought it was cute you know. But that did it for me. That's what I was going to be — a piano player in a big band. All right, now we go back to the waiting room where all the noisy kids are. And a woman came out and she said, "Can anybody out here play the piano?" Because she was saddled with this room full of kids, chattering kids, kids that could recite poetry you know. So I held my hand up and came in and so I was pressed into service as the accompanist for tap dancers, baton twirlers and singers and so forth. But at this point I could transpose. That was no problem, and I already knew most of the tunes because everybody listened to the radio you know. And so I went through the whole thing, auditioned the whole thing, and so I kept waiting for her to say won't you play some? I

wanted to be on the show you know. And she never got around to that. I was crushed, you know. I thought if I'm good enough to play for all these kids, why doesn't she ask me to appear on the program? And I was just getting ready to go out the door and she said "And by the way," she said, "could you please be back here next Saturday, we have auditions every Saturday." And so I thought that was better than nothing. And my father popped up and said, "Well Jane is accustomed to being paid a small stipend." My father was an attorney by the way.

MR: Good. I was going to say, did he what kind of bread are we talking about?

JJ: Well at that point in time fifty cents would have been a large nest you know. So I can't remember what actually happened, but at any rate, I not only then began playing for all these Saturday auditions, and finally, somebody said, "Well if she can play for the auditions, she should play for the children on the show." So then I became the official accompanist see, by default. Then after about six or eight months of this, nobody had any idea how old I was. Because I never did look young. I never had a young face, and it just never crossed their minds that anybody that could do what I was doing could be literally a child. At any rate after a few months of this, their regular staff house pianist summarily walked out one day, and they asked me if I'd like to be the staff pianist for the radio station. Well I couldn't believe my good fortune but I was sure my parents wouldn't let me do it. But to my astonishment, my parents had a pow wow and Mother was very big into the public school system, she made a special trip and spoke to my principal and she said, "My daughter has an unparalleled opportunity, could she possibly be excused from study halls and let her stay home the first two hours in the morning?" I worked until twelve o'clock at night, would you believe this? And I mean when I think about, now isn't this—

MR: You were twelve? Eleven or twelve?

JJ: Yeah, by this time I was about twelve. And the principal agreed with her because she was a very persuasive person. And he said as long as my grades were kept up. So that went on for a year. And finally I lost the job because they found out that, you know the child welfare people found out and admonished my parents for having put me in a sweat shop, a musical sweat shop.

MR: A good experience though.

JJ: You see this set a norm for my life. I was able then to move, I was able to go anywhere and say "I've had two years experience on staff at a radio station." And I had publicity to support it. Is that too long-winded to start out?

MR: No, that was great.

JJ: But it did set up, it gave me a lot of faith in myself, and I knew what I wanted.

MR: Right. You must have developed the kind of ear that was going to serve you well later on for the other things you've done.

JJ: And you can imagine, when I actually graduated into really accompanying people that came, I accompanied for big stars. Ethel Waters for example, and it was not the same as it is today. If they had something to peddle, like a book or an appearance, they would come to the radio station to generate interest in themselves. So these people would come and they'd say, "Can you play 'Stormy Weather' in the key of C" or whatever it was, and so I began doing that. I can't tell you all the names that were famous that I played for as a child.

MR: Wow. That's wonderful. What was the next big event in your musical growth?

JJ: Well, my parents were killed by a train. And so some terrible tragedy like that you know really brings out the kindness in people. And so a lot of people became interested in me that probably would have said oh isn't that too bad and that would be the end of it. But I was sent in to Chicago to get instruction and wound up, I always got scholarships. And I got my first scholarship, it was a Bush Conservatory, which then became Chicago Conservatory, which then became the music school for Loyola University. And I also had a scholarship at DePaul University. And this was, there was so much attention you see, my mother being in the school system, in the public school system, it was general knowledge about this youngster, and I had no brothers or sisters. It was just like a novel. In fact my whole life is like a novel.

MR: I see a book there, don't you?

JJ: Well, come to think of it— Okay, now did I answer the question there?

MR: You started, you had some more formal education.

JJ: The big problem in music, is you had to either go to the education formula, or cast your wits against the world in jazz. Because there was no forum, mind you, eighty years ago. Not eighty years ago, well, in 1929 is when all this took place. In 1929, there was no place for a woman to play jazz. Now I was friends with Mary Lou Williams, because she and Andy Kirk were at the Club Alabam, which was right on my way to Bush Conservatory, and I used to sit and listen to the rehearsals. Big bands used to rehearse, you know, in the afternoons. And that's where I met her.

MR: And Chicago was a pretty happening town for music, right?

JJ: Oh at that point, but of course I was too young to go anywhere, but wasn't it clever of me to get a scholarship at a Conservatory where I could walk right past where Mary Lou Williams was?

MR: Good thinking.

JJ: So if you did play jazz, there was no place to go unless you could get in with a big band. There were women bands at that time, but that kind of life didn't appeal to me, and

besides, I wanted to be in a man's band, see? Because it was more powerful at that point. And women's bands did not get recognition.

MR: They were a novelty almost?

JJ: Yeah. They were a novelty. And I didn't like that. So it was easier for me to go the radio and eventually television route. And then I used my ability to play jazz to earn money other than that.

MR: So your career, now you've done all that already, you did some television work. When did the whole thing with the ball clubs come about?

JJ: Well, what happened, when I tell this, it doesn't seem possible. When the Milwaukee Braves, who had been the Boston Braves, moved to Milwaukee, the owners told me that, they called me out of the blue and asked me if I'd like to be an organist for the ball club. And I thought somebody was kidding me you know. Because I took music so seriously and that seemed so frivolous you know. And they said, it was the most left handed compliment I've ever had in my life, the man said to me, he was the president of the new Milwaukee Braves, said, "Well we need an organist and we don't know whether you're anything good or not, but every time we ask somebody who a good organist is, your name always comes up. And we want to know if you'd like to come in and talk to us about the job." Well to me that was just some more extra money you know, and I'd never been to a baseball game. I couldn't even get a passing grade in gym. And my eyes cross if throw a ball at me you know. So I think I was the most unlikely person on earth to do be a sports organist. At any rate, I'll never forget that interview that they explained baseball to me. "Now the men get up with the bat, and they throw the ball, three strikes and you're out. Don't play unless the club is leaving the field." So then they got nervous about me interrupting the game, and decided that they'd only have me play at the beginning, at the ending, and play "Take Me Out to the Ball Game" in the middle. So after they became certain that I wouldn't wreck the National League, they let me, you know, begin to play.

MR: I'll bet you can plan [sings] in all twelve keys.

JJ: I never did play that.

MR: You never played that?

JJ: No.

MR: Is that a hockey thing maybe?

JJ: No that started in baseball, and I don't know who started it. I could kill 'em for it.

MR: Well good for you, you had your own approach.

JJ: And it was without so saying. You know I didn't absolutely refuse to do it. I just didn't do it. And it was a wonder that I didn't get fired. But for some reason or other I didn't. And it was a marvelous experience.

MR: Were you raising a family at this time?

JJ: Yes, I had two little kids.

MR: You must have been rather busy.

JJ: I got married and so I moved to New York.

MR: And then you got hooked up with the Mets too.

JJ: Yeah, well that— what had happened was I received a phone call from John McHale, who was, at that point, president of the Milwaukee Braves. He wanted to know if I'd like to move to Atlanta, because the club was, this was before it was generally known you know, and would I like to move to Atlanta. And I decided no, I would, as long as I was going to make a move it was going to be a complete one, and where else but New York for jazz. So I went to the new club owners of the New York Mets and they hired me because I had experience.

MR: Well good. Now when you got into New York and a different atmosphere, were you able to get into the jazz scene? What was that like?

JJ: Well I'd only been in New York 24 hours and the first job I had was with Milt Hinton. And Osie Johnson was on drums. And I thought, oh, I've got it made. Well I can't tell you how long I waited for a job after that. But then I did, I was engaged by Muzak Corporation. And I graduated from programmer until I became a producer and then I became the vice president. So that's another whole career in music.

MR: You were producing the recordings?

JJ: Yes. I produced over 300.

MR: Wow. So you got to bring in some—

JJ: And so I met all the jazz musicians you know, although many of them I knew before like Clark Terry. But I produced a number of albums, or CDs we call them now, that they are on. It gave me an opportunity to arrange and to compose.

MR: Now your composing, you've been honored by ASCAP I believe—

JJ: Yes.

MR: And you were fairly prolific, and how do you describe your own music?

JJ: Well I'll tell you, it speaks of the diffuseness of my life, my musical life. I'm able to compose and arrange serious music, but it doesn't interest me anymore because it stays, you know, once having written it, it stays. You don't have the opportunity to jab at classical music. I'm constitutionally unable to play anything the same way. I cannot remember after I've done it, what I've done. The only way I've ever been able to jot down what I play is, you know, when it's been recorded.

MR: And listen back to it.

JJ: And listen back to it. And sometimes I'm surprised and sometimes I run screaming from the room, that I'm the—I can actually compose in almost any idiom. And I can do the same thing with arranging. But at this point in time, I just play what interests me.

Because I don't have to do it for, I don't have to please anybody but myself and the audience. I mean I have no employer of course, that's what I mean.

MR: Right. Do you sit at the piano when you compose or do you sit at a desk?

JJ: No. Anywhere.

MR: It's hard for people to understand how that happens.

JJ: Well as a matter of fact it mixes me up if I go to the piano, because I'll find myself noodling instead of — it's better for me to stay away from the piano. Anywhere. I can sit anywhere and do it.

MR. The ideas of promoting your work has now been hooked up with the Statesmen.

JJ: Well I'll tell you, this is another one of the great eurekas of my life you know. First of all, to play with such genuinely learned people as these statesmen, is an experience that I can't begin to tell you what a thrill it is. And they all, jazz musicians keep learning from each other. Every time we play it's just an eye opener for me.

MR: Maybe I should explain for our viewers that the Statesmen of Jazz, and hopefully they will have heard of you all by the time we watch this, but it's a group that you have to be over 65, right? And all our finest jazz musicians available have been put into a working group and they're putting together tours and just presenting music that's timeless, and very exciting to be a part of. It was a thrill to watch you in front of the kids the other day too, who really were like, "Wow look at that." And the kids would come up and say, "And they didn't have any music either." And I think it's just a fabulous idea.

JJ: Well I sure hope that it continues on. Because it does something really wonderful for the performer. You walk out of there and you're in a dream you know, from the wonderful experience, because these people, they know exactly what they're doing, and they play with such surety. And there is such professionalism in the way, there's an expression that jazz musicians use, called hand off, where it's time for somebody else to play, and so you have a very courteous way, musically, of setting the stage for the person coming up. And you appreciate it more when you've had this wealth of experience behind you, and then you hear this wealth of experience from the others.

MR: They set you up, and then, thank you very much for letting me come in that way.

JJ: That's exactly it. It's just like being on a cushion.

MR: Yeah. Neat. When I listen to you play, I'm thinking, first I heard your recording, before I heard you live, I felt like I was being taken back, almost to a ballroom type of style, and then said oh, it's not quite that pretty. You've really got some nice rhythmic things happening there and some really muscular type playing. And last night I'm listening to you and I'm thinking, it sounds like Dave Brubeck took lessons from you or something.

JJ: Oh that's so wonderful to hear.

MR: Yeah. I mean you tend to like to play two-handed style sometimes, and it really punches—

JJ: Yeah, I'm so respectful of harmony. But each, you see each musician, if you're accompanying a horn instrument for example, you must play differently underneath them. You find what you think sounds good, but it won't sound that good on every song. It's something that applies right that given moment in time, and no other. But you don't play the same thing beneath a trombone that you do under a tenor. I mean it depends what register they're using or whether they're playing legato or whether they're playing in a breathy fashion. So this is what you call instant assessment of what you're doing.

MR: We've been talking about getting people's opinion on the Count Basie Orchestra, Basie as a musician and also Joe Williams.

JJ: Oh, you're talking about some favorite subjects of mine. Well I think, you know there's no doubt that Joe Williams and Count Basie changed the public's concept of jazz I think, because Count Basie was a very engaging piano player. Now this was not always so. When he played with just small groups, he played like any hot jazz pianist, you know. The style that he used with his big band was altogether different, and they were both wonderful. But if he had, he was wise enough, let me put it that way, that he knew the appropriateness of what he did. And so he wasn't going to be so set in his ways. He moved into a new mode, as any jazz musician should do, you move into new modes. You don't make the mode fit you. And that's, I admired him so greatly for that. I've studied his early records with that small group, the one that Claude "The Fiddler" Williams who is playing on the Statesmen of Jazz, he was a remarkable musician. He of course was a guitarist first, and is now playing violin. I don't know exactly why he turned to the violin, or perhaps he started with the violin.

MR: I think from what he told us he had played them together at the same time.

JJ: Had he? Like I always did, pipe organ you know, so when the rage of the electric organ first and then the electronic organ, it was a simple matter for me.

MR: Did you have opportunities to hear the Basie band a number of times?

JJ: Yes. Whenever I possibly could. And of course thank God for television, because we got to see quite a bit of that in the latter years. But he had such a wonderful, he and Duke Ellington both achieved a wonderful concept of an orchestral sound and a style. Now this is an incredible thing to do, because you know there are literally thousands of jazz bands and how many of them are distinctive? And he was distinctive. Now to get back to Joe Williams of course, I had heard Joe sing, you know for years and years I'd been a fan of his. And when I moved to New York I became friends with the same sort of a musical association that he had, I'm talking about social. And so I knew him largely as just a person that you sit and chat with you know. So that's an unusual experience to have. I

think he's also an amazing singer. And he took the blues out of the sin and gin era, and you know the dark, dank music halls or clubs or anything—

MR: Yeah, the wrong side of town.

JJ: Yeah, that's exactly it.

MR: That's what Milt was saying when I asked him about that.

JJ: Oh did he? Well then certainly my appraisal is right, because if Milt said it, it's genuine. At any rate, Joe just elevated it to a real art form. And without its losing any of its generic sound you know. And not only that, he's a thoroughly nice man, and he is a vocal instrumentalist. He could, what he sings could be played on a horn and start a whole new career. And he's a charming man, a good man. I'm very fond of him and proud of him. He's done so much for jazz.

MR: He's charmed us at Hamilton a few times.

JJ: Well that's good news.

MR: Yeah. Do you want to take a little break?

[off the record pause]

MR: When you were, let's go back to your teen years and you started listening, there was a lot of jazz on the radio is that right?

JJ: Oh, yes.

MR: Who were the players that grabbed your ear?

JJ: Well first of all you see I played organ. By this time I was accomplished somewhat on the organ. And so I looked at everything from an orchestral point of view. And my favorite bands at that time, when I was a teenager, were the McKinney Cotton Pickers, Fletcher Henderson, Lucky Millinder and then Duke. I imagined Duke may have come in there earlier. And Earl "Fatha" Hines, not so much for his band but he was a remarkable pianist that really caused all jazz pianists to re-think what they were doing. He you know, the style of piano playing before Duke and before Earl Hines was that you just sort of copied what you already heard, what was already being played. It was almost ensemble rhythm and if you didn't do that you played [scats]. Now Duke you see changed all that. But Earl Hines changed the mechanics of the playing. He was the first one, to my knowledge at least, to make the left hand important harmonically as well as melodically. And he introduced tenths, you know, he had fingers that just went on and on and on and on. So it was no task for him. Up until then, and even after he introduced the solid playing of a tenth, there was a kind of a scooping motion that pianists used [scats]—

MR: To get it all in.

JJ: Yeah, to get it all in because they couldn't reach it. Duke, on the other hand, I'll quote my piano teacher at Bush Conservatory. She was a classical pianist and didn't know anything about jazz, conceptually, but she did say that he knew more about keyboard harmony

than any living person. Now of course this was many years ago. I wasn't too sure of what she meant until I began to study what he did. Because so many people think a pianist is a person that plays, you know lots of little frills or lots and lots of heavy rhythm, or a combination. I'm talking about early concepts now of jazz. Whereas Duke looked upon the piano as an orchestral instrument. And you know once in a while he'd play an arpeggio. But he wasn't known for whooping around all over the notes. He made every note important. My piano teacher said, "He knows how to get from here to there with the least commotion."

MR: Least commotion, I like that.

JJ: He had such a solid knowledge of what chords constitute, uh, what constitutes chords, and their different positions, that he could play what it would take anybody else twenty minutes to do, to get from here to there you know. And at that point, when she said that, it didn't really, it was too big to grasp. Because piano just wasn't played that way. So at any rate, what was I talking about?

MR: We were talking about people that you were listening to and maybe absorbing.

JJ: Unfortunately, well there weren't too many women pianists that came to the fore, because it just was unthinkable. Women were supposed to be in the more sedate careers.

MR: At what point were you able to, as far as getting calls to play jazz gigs and then combo, and then get on record. At what point did that start to change for you?

JJ: Well I got the first jobs by default. Some good male pianist couldn't make it, and everybody knew I could either sight read a written arrangement or I could play. And then the vocalists never sing in E flat, B flat or D flat. They sing in B and E and A. And it didn't make any difference to me what key I played in, and so I became in demand for singers. So I think I was a comforting kind of jazz pianist in the beginning. And even if I had, even if I had flourished, there wouldn't have been any place to play. The only place you could play would be in hotels, or just insufferable beer joints.

MR: Doing sing-a-longs?

JJ: Yeah. Where people wouldn't think of, well you wouldn't get hired if you told them you were a jazz musician. As a matter of fact, I don't think I would have even been hired to play for the Milwaukee Braves and the New York Mets if I had said yes I'm a jazz organist. I don't think I would have. I mean it would have been an anathema. It's barely possible. But the public mind had such a fix on that, that people would say, "Oh I don't like jazz," they didn't even know what it was. So what do you think I did? I played jazz in both ballparks. And that's how come Lionel Hampton and Roy Eldridge and I all became real close friends, because they heard me play at the ballparks.

MR: It's not, unfortunately there's not a lot of women instrumentalists still in jazz you know.

JJ: No there really isn't.

MR: We have you and we have Marian McPartland.

JJ: Dorothy Donegan. And there are plenty of fine women musicians out there that lose heart because there's no place to go. And there are night clubs to play in. I admire the younger generation because they don't know all this terrible stuff, and so they're just striking out. And I think there's a very good chance that they will prevail. Because they're not saddled with this baggage of knowing that you aren't going to be invited. But I've been extremely fortunate that I've always played with the fine—

MR: Well eventually you got in with some great people. Like who? Name a few for us.

JJ: Well Lionel Hampton is one. Clark Terry, I played in both their bands. And I played in all, well not all, but many of the jazz festivals. And I recorded with a number of the biggies. And I don't think any of the men now look upon me, they don't look upon me as anything but just a jazz musician. I've overcome that. But you know I hate to make too much of a point of this, but I do believe that men are really more comfortable with their own, with their own gender. And I don't think it's prejudice as much as it is logistics. I know of a couple of jobs that I could have been invited on but they got to thinking, how are we going to handle this logistic business? I do think that has been the biggest drawback.

MR: Well you've got now some people that instead of you saying you played with them, you can say that they played with you. Because you've got a few albums out and you've got some good tunes.

JJ: I've had wonderful luck, and traveled all over the world, in one of my lives or another. And with a little luck, this group will continue on. And even if we don't continue on I think that we've opened up a whole avenue for people our age. I don't think we'll be looked upon, we haven't really on an individual basis been kept out of any, I'm trying to say we flourished in spite of everything. But to this business of formation of the Statesmen of Jazz is to pay homage to people that have prevailed and have succeeded and to give heart to those who haven't been as fortunate and who keep on plodding, because, what is that old saying, you can't learn it if you're not in it. I don't know whether that's an old saying.

MR: Well a number of people have said that in different ways they've heard about someone suggesting that, I'm surprised you haven't retired. And it's like why would I want to do that? It's what I do. Why should I do that?

JJ: Oh, as long as you can play, so what if you hobble a little.

MR: It takes a little longer to get to the stage, but, you know, it's worth it when you get there.

JJ: And thank God I've been able to keep right on playing, and there's no end in sight. And I could tell you that I'm so proud of your school, of the marvelous thing you're doing, to

document these things. Because we should, we need to encourage young people to make jazz their career, but to explore the field, and to be messengers of jazz.

MR: And like when we were talking in the beginning, we need to have informed audiences also, which I think is the great thing that the Federation is trying to do. You have to have people to listen to it as well as play it.

JJ: Whereas in years past we've all thought about our own particular careers in music you know. But the time has come we have to seriously consider the audience.

MR: Great. Well thanks so much for being with us today.

JJ: Well it's been a joy and I'm very proud to be with you.

MR: On behalf of the Hamilton College Jazz Archive we'd like to thank Jane Jarvis, pianist, arranger, composer, ballpark entertainer, and on and on, and it's been a great pleasure. And I hope your gig goes well tonight. And I hope we see you in November and I hope that's a great birthday bash for you.

JJ: Oh, I'm going to take roll call. You'd better be there.

MR: Okay, thank you so much.

JJ: Bye-bye. And thanks.